

contribute to Sony Audio's revenue stream?

A Owing to the increasing popularity of OTT content consumption and with the vast library of Dolby Vision and Dolby Atmos content, there has been a huge surge in the demand for large-screen televisions and premium soundbars as consumers seek to replicate a cinematic experience in their homes.

We have been leading the premium soundbar category and have achieved double-digit growth in FY22 as our premium soundbars make a significant contribution to the audio category's overall revenue stream. We have invested heavily in cutting-edge technology to offer soundbars that deliver an immersive audio experience and seamlessly integrate with other devices.

Q Sony has had a dominating presence in the Active Noise Cancellation space for audio products. How does Sony stay ahead of the curve and maintain this presence over brands such as Bose?

A Sony has been a dominant player in the Active Noise Cancellation (ANC) market for audio products for several years now. Our unwavering com-

mitment to product excellence and relentless pursuit for technological innovation has enabled us to stay ahead of the curve and maintain our leadership position in the ANC segment. We attribute a major part of this success to the 1000X series headphones, which we introduced in 2016. Since then, these headphones have set a new benchmark for noise cancellation performance and we have continued to build on that foundation by constantly improving and developing the QN1/V1 Integrated Processor, which powers our ANC technology. This has resulted in us providing the best-in-class consumer music listening experience to our consumers.

Q ANC has been the next big thing in the audio industry for a while. What is the next big thing Sony's R&D team is working on?

A At Sony, we are committed to innovation and constantly exploring ways to integrate cutting-edge technology into people's lives. As we look into the future, we believe that wearables will play an increasingly important role in our daily life as the boundary between online and offline becomes increasingly blurred. Our focus is on developing wearables that offer a seamless,

intuitive user experience and leveraging the latest advancements.

Q Sony's latest ANC headphone - the Sony WH-CH720N provides users with a good ANC option under 10K. Considering India has a price-conscious audience, will Sony be developing more inexpensive ANC headphones? What are the compromises made to bring down the price?

A We are unable to comment on future product line-up and there will always be a product for every consumer with their growing demands.

Q Will Bluetooth LE change how we use headphones in the future and what are the benefits?

A Bluetooth LE technology is a next-generation Bluetooth audio that offers ultra-low latency, improved battery life, and enhanced connectivity. Its low latency makes it ideal for gaming and real-time audio, providing an immersive experience. Additionally, it offers longer listening sessions and stable, reliable connections between headphones and audio devices, eliminating the need for wires. Bluetooth LE technology has the potential to revolutionize the headphone category with improved audio quality and greater connectivity.

Q Companies like KZ, Lypertek and even OPPO have been in the space of including dual and triple drivers to improve sonic fidelity for a while. Is Sony experimenting with the same? If yes, why? If not, why?

A Sony has been a pioneer in the audio industry and we believe that the best listening experience is not solely dependent on the number of drivers and it is essential to reproduce sound with high-quality drivers and advanced processing technologies. For instance, Sony's Edge-AI (Artificial Intelligence) and DSEE Extreme technology upscale compressed music files in real-time to provide consumers with the best possible listening experience. **[i]**

